Interim CEO roadmap: a first scaffold

By **Judith Mueller**, candidate for the Interim CEO role

Version 1 · 17 October 2026 · A mock-up by a candidate for the Interim CEO role. Not a Verity document.

Built only from the application pack and public information. Initial research, to be updated.

1 At a glance

Verity has achieved what few charities do, almost entirely through volunteers: it was the only patient organisation on the global committee that renamed the condition, it set up the UK's first parliamentary group on it, and it has a seat on the committee for the NICE guideline due in January.

Your pack asks the Interim CEO for an agreed roadmap within six weeks, and for two jobs above all: an income base that can fund a permanent CEO, and becoming an employer for the first time. This is how I would start. It is a scaffold, built only from the pack and public information. It shows how I would structure the work, who is involved in each step, what waits on whom, and what six months can and cannot deliver. Much of it would change once I knew Verity from the inside.

I would love to build it out with you. Whoever is appointed, you are very welcome to use it.

Judith Mueller, candidate for the Interim CEO role

Verity today

initial research, to be updated

Real figure · Extrapolation, to be updated · Gap, to be filled

MONEY

£88.8k
Income, year to March 2025
Filed accounts

about £100k
Income, latest year (Verity's figure)
Application pack, page 7

81%
Restricted share of 2024/25 income
Filed accounts

£17.2k
Unrestricted income, 2024/25
Filed accounts

£10.5k
Free reserves, 31 March 2025
Filed accounts

to be filled
Funders, amounts and end dates
Pre-start questions: documents

to be filled
2025/26 accounts
Due by 31 December 2026

PEOPLE

4
Registered trustees
Charity Commission

to be filled
New trustees who joined in 2026
Pre-start questions: about you

1
Part-time administrator
Application pack

0
Employees
Application pack; filed accounts

to be filled
Trustee time on operations today
Pre-start questions: time log

REACH

12,000+ members
Private Facebook support group
Verity's website

16K followers
Facebook page
Facebook, 17 October 2026

about 46,000
Website visits, 2024/25
Filed accounts

200+
Information packs a year
Filed accounts

9.6 out of 10
PMOS TIME rating by health professionals
Application pack

POSITION

27 January 2027
NICE guideline on PMOS
NICE's own project page

12 May 2026, three-year transition
Renaming to PMOS
Application pack; The Lancet

since April 2025, 10 recommendations
APPG on PMOS
Application pack

James Lind Alliance Top 10
Research priorities
Application pack

SYSTEMS

Donorbox and JustGiving
Online donations
Verity's website

to be filled
What Verity uses today for supporters, finance, HR and files
Pre-start questions: systems list

◆ *Suggested systems*
Supporter database with Gift Aid and consent records; finance and payroll; HR and volunteers; marketing and communications; Board papers and risk register; impact data; shared files and secure access; and others, to be mapped
My suggestion, to be mapped together

What needs to get done

Job 1 **An income base that can fund a permanent part-time CEO**
"build an income base that can fund a permanent part-time CEO at the end of the interim period" (pack, page 7)

Job 2 **Ready to employ for the first time**
"put in place the systems and structures that allow Verity to become an employer for the first time" (pack, page 7)

Everything else in the pack "serves those two aims". The six accountabilities, with the pack's own end-of-contract tests, are in section 2.

How this scaffold becomes the roadmap

Before the start date	Goodwill days: introduction calls and pre-start questions (section 4)
End of week 2	The first full roadmap, fleshed out from this scaffold
Weeks 3 to 5	Tested with every trustee
Week 6	Agreed by the Board, then tracked month by month on this dashboard

The contract clock would start on Monday 4 January 2027.

2 The six tests: the pack's accountabilities and its end-of-contract tests

The pack sets six accountabilities, each with a test of what must be true by the end of the contract. Every step in the roadmap feeds at least one of them, and progress would be shown here month by month; today each is at zero. Under each test are the workstreams that feed it: ● from the pack, ◆ a suggested addition.

1 Financial sustainability and income generation

By the end of the contract: an income strategy agreed by the Board with targets, owners and timescales; a live grants pipeline with a stated value; and a clear picture of the funding secured towards the permanent post and the gap remaining.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Funding deadlines before January: open funds, trustee-led
- ● Income strategy and pipeline
- ● Income streams, including PMOS TIME
- ● Staffing model: people and systems
- ● Business case and funding gap

Pack, page 8

2 Building the infrastructure to become an employer

By the end of the contract: an employer-readiness plan signed off by the Board, providers appointed, and systems documented and in use.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Staffing model: people and systems
- ● Employer readiness
- ● Systems mapping and build

Pack, page 8

3 Strategic and operational leadership

By the end of the contract: an agreed roadmap in place within the first six weeks, and trustees spending materially less time on operational delivery than at the start.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Introductions and pre-start questions
- ● Roadmap and leadership
- ◆ People, skills and resources map

Pack, page 8

4 Governance and organisational leadership

By the end of the contract: an agreed scheme of delegation, a consistent Board reporting pack, and clear role descriptions across the team.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Set-up and compliance
- ● Governance and the Board report
- ◆ People, skills and resources map

Pack, page 9

5 Impact, external profile, risk and compliance

By the end of the contract: key relationships mapped and held organisationally, agreed impact measures with baseline data, and a live risk register reviewed at every Board meeting.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Impact, relationships and risk
- ● External representation
- ◆ Media and communications capability

Pack, page 9

6 Transition and handover

By the end of the contract: a defined and costed permanent CEO role with a recruitment plan, and a written handover pack completed before the contract ends.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Permanent CEO and handover

Pack, page 9

On external work (accountability 5): I would take on as much as the Board wants, at its pace, alongside the trustees who lead it.

3 The roadmap: who does what, when, and what it waits on

The top three rows are the overview: the Board decisions the work depends on, key dates fixed by others, and the Interim CEO's days each month, planned against available. Below them is every step, grouped by job.

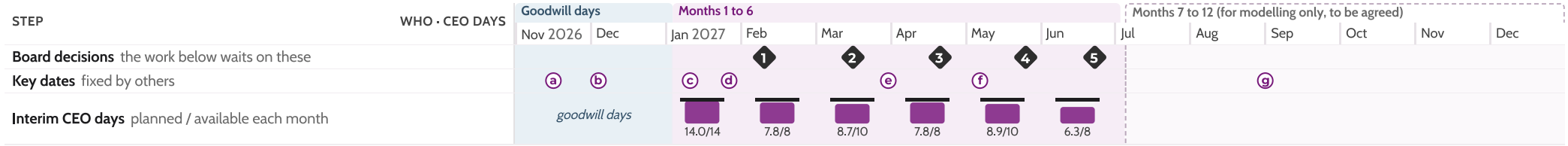
Bars Interim CEO days · Led by trustees or the administrator · Goodwill days · Waiting on others

Time Before the start date: goodwill days · Months 1 to 6: the contract · Months 7 to 12: for modelling only

Markers Board decision, numbered · Key date · Milestone

Where it comes from From Verity's application pack · Suggested additions to the pack

A1 to A6 the pack's six accountabilities (section 2)



BOARD DECISIONS

1. **Week 6:** Roadmap agreed by the Board, after testing with every trustee
2. **March:** Scheme of delegation agreed; Income strategy agreed
3. **April:** Employer-readiness plan signed off; Staffing model, reserves policy and impact measures
4. **May:** Business case for the permanent post
5. **June:** Month-6 decision: the second half, when to recruit, and media roles and budget

Board decisions could be taken at a meeting or by email, as the Board prefers.

KEY DATES

- (a) **16 November 2026:** Rosa, the UK fund for women and girls: applications close (4pm)
- (b) **4 December 2026:** The Fore, a funder of small charities: registration closes (midday)
- (c) **11 January 2027:** The Fore: application deadline, if Verity is drawn
- (d) **27 January 2027:** NICE guideline on PMOS expected
- (e) **31 March 2027:** Last day to claim Gift Aid on 2022/23 donations
- (f) **7 May 2027:** The Fore: decisions (early May)
- (g) **1 September 2027:** PMOS Awareness Month begins

Funding dates come from the funders' own websites: open funds Verity could apply to. The NICE date is from NICE's own project page.

INTERIM CEO DAYS

Weeks 1 and 2 at five days (my suggestion, to build momentum), then two days a week. Months 7 to 12 are shown at one day a week, for modelling only. Days not yet allocated are kept for the day-to-day and the unexpected. Before the start date: goodwill days, not charged.

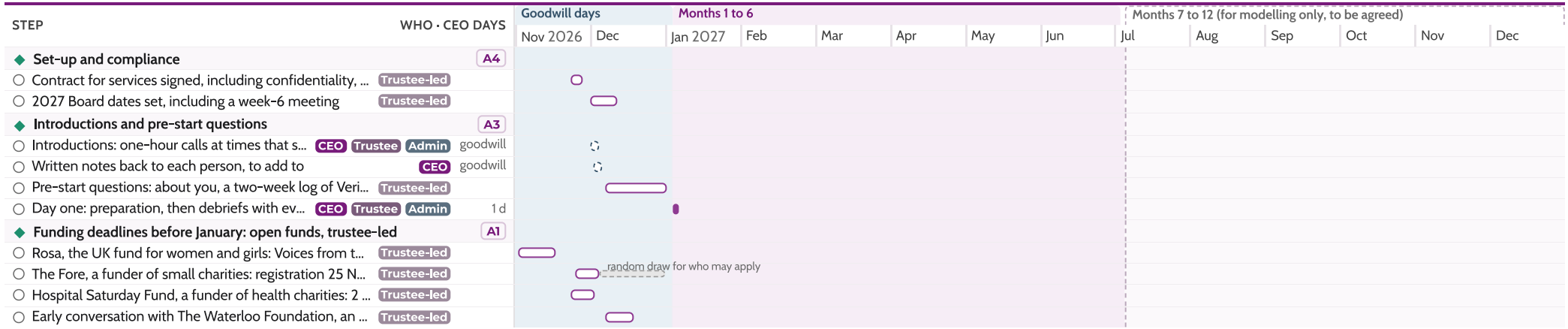
Every step, by job

Each row is one step. The tags show who is involved, and the number is the Interim CEO days it takes.

CEO Interim CEO · Admin with the administrator · Trustee with one or more trustees · Board with the whole Board · Trustee-led led by trustees or the administrator · External external: funders, HMRC, providers

Before the start date: goodwill days

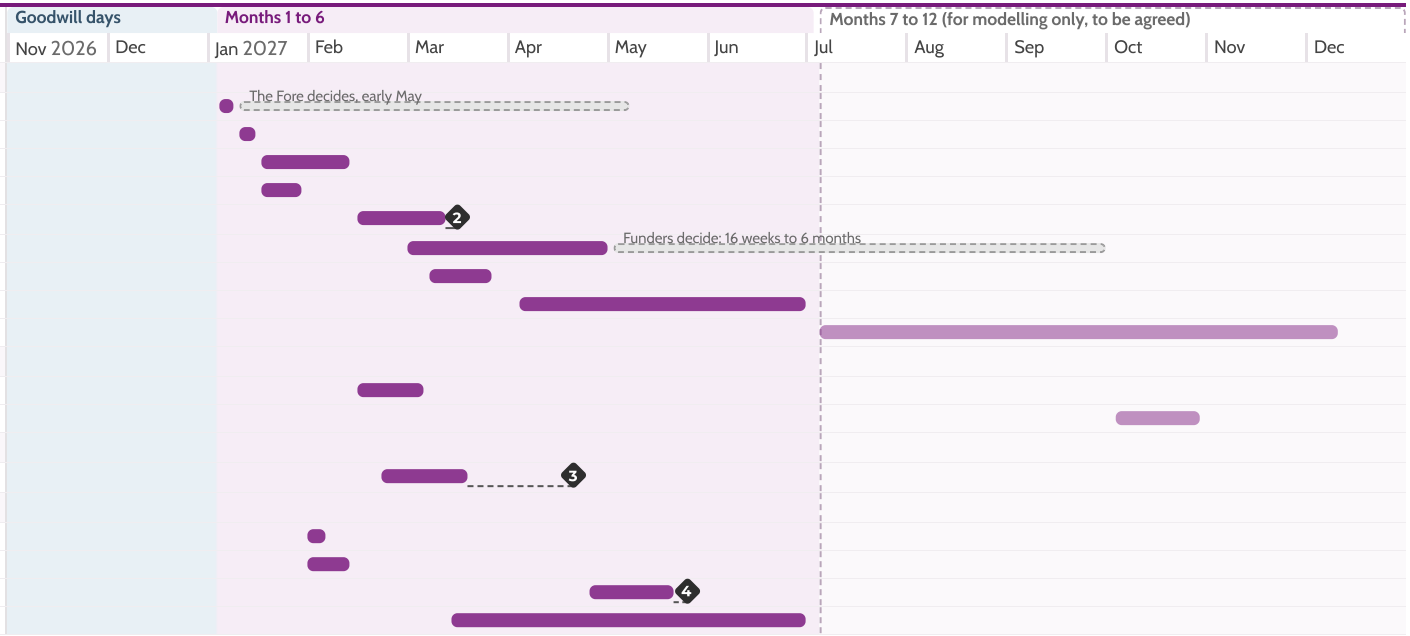
Not charged, at times that suit you: introductions and pre-start questions



Job 1: an income base for a permanent CEO

Accountabilities 1 and 2

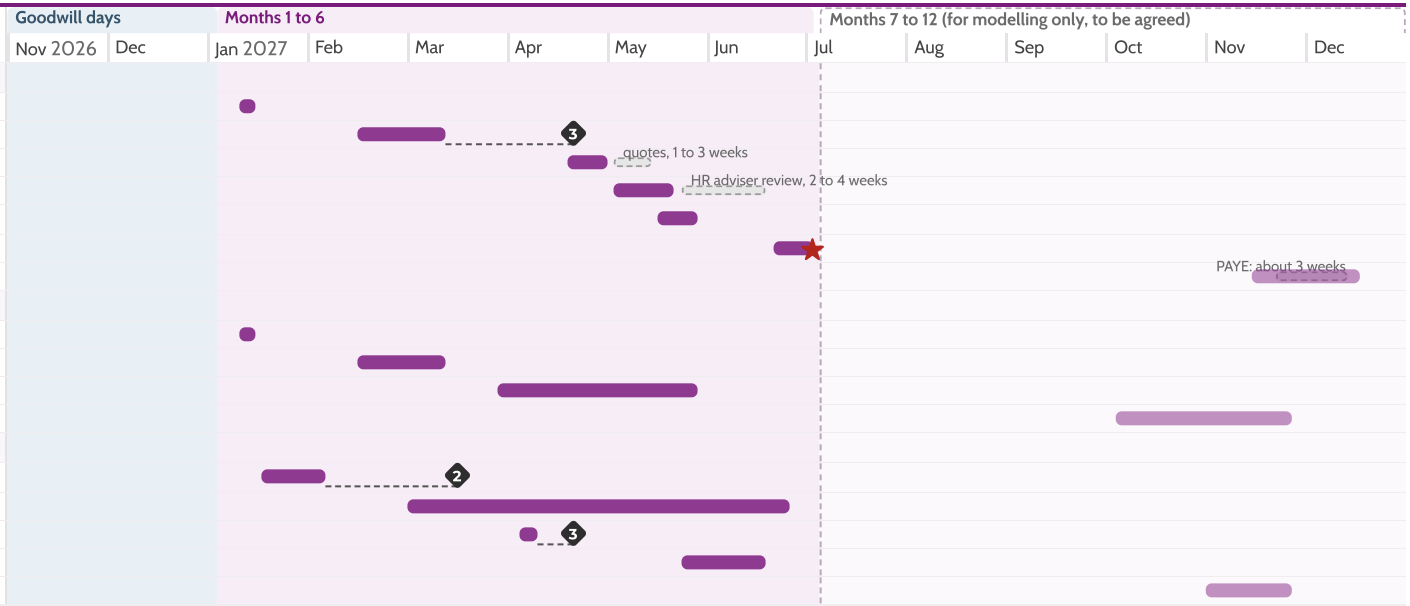
STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS
Income strategy and pipeline	A1
The Fore application, if Verity is drawn (deadline 11 J...	CEO Trustee 1 d
Money map: income streams, funders, restricted fu...	CEO Trustee 1 d
Pipeline built on Verity's grant strategy	CEO 1.25 d
NICE moment: patient appeal and a monthly giving...	CEO Trustee 0.5 d
Income strategy, built on the grant strategy	CEO 1.5 d
Applications: Waterloo, Garfield Weston, Big Give; A...	CEO Trustee 4 d
Check all eligible Gift Aid is claimed (2022/23 windo...	CEO Admin 0.5 d
Pipeline and funder relationships, monthly	CEO 2 d
Decisions stewarded; second round; Big Give; Aware...	CEO Trustee 7 d
Income streams, including PMOS TIME	A1
Income streams review, including growing PMOS TIME inco...	CEO 1 d
PMOS at work: an employer offer, PMOS TIME licences	CEO 1 d
Staffing model: people and systems	A2 A1
Where Verity needs people, and where systems	CEO Board 1.5 d
Business case and funding gap	A1
First outline: permanent role and cost range	CEO 0.5 d
Budget and cash-flow forecast, with the Treasurer	CEO Trustee 0.5 d
Costed business case for the permanent post	CEO Trustee 1.5 d
Funding secured and gap remaining, in every Board report	CEO 0.5 d



Job 2: ready to employ

Accountabilities 2 and 4

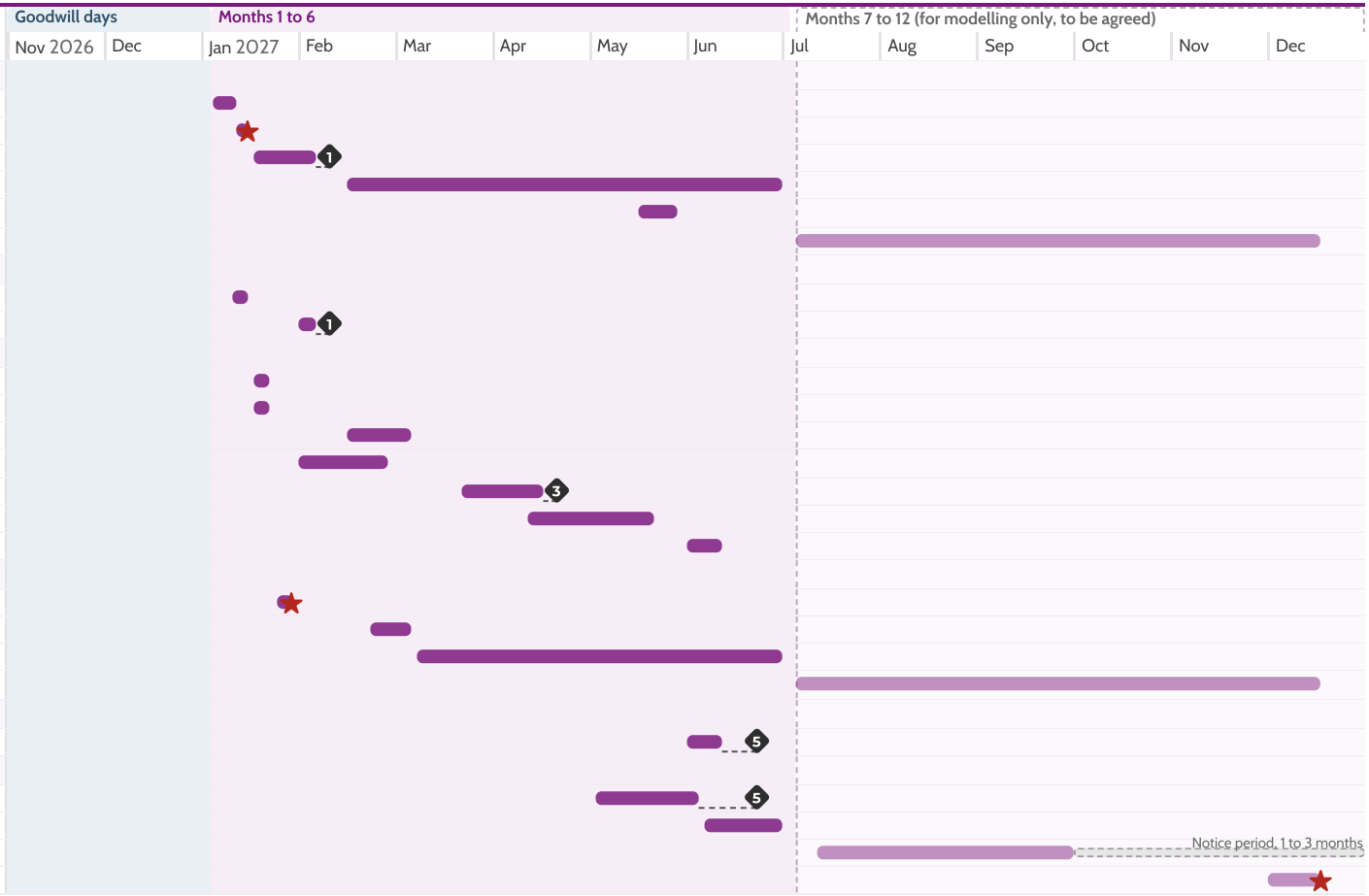
STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS
Employer readiness	A2
What exists already, and the administrator's arrange...	CEO Admin 0.5 d
Sequenced, costed employer-readiness plan (indicative costs)	CEO 1.5 d
Formal quotes and choice: payroll, pension, insuran...	CEO External 1 d
Handbook and policies drafted; existing policies upd...	CEO Admin 2.5 d
Roles beyond the CEO, and the order to recruit	CEO Board 0.5 d
Providers appointed; processes written do...	CEO Admin External 1 d
First hire: PAYE, pension, insurance, right to...	CEO Admin External 1.5 d
Systems mapping and build	A2
Systems map: what we have, would like, and is missi...	CEO Admin 0.5 d
Build or buy plan, incl. a supporter database...	CEO Admin Trustee 1.5 d
First builds; processes written down	CEO Admin 1.5 d
The live dashboard with login and comments; more automat...	CEO 2 d
Governance and the Board report	A4
Compliance calendar, risk register, conflicts register, Board re...	CEO 1.5 d
The Board report before each meeting, with trustee...	CEO Trustee 2.25 d
Reserves policy	CEO 0.5 d
Role descriptions across the team	CEO Trustee Admin 1 d
Board skills review and renewal plan	CEO Board 1 d



Running and protecting Verity

Accountabilities 3, 5 and 6

STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS	
Roadmap and leadership		A3
Read and assess everything gathered	CEO	3.5 d
First full roadmap, fleshed out from this scaffold	CEO	1 d
Roadmap tested with every trustee	CEO Trustee	2 d
Day-to-day operations moved off trustees; dashbo…	CEO Trustee	1.5 d
Trustee time measured again (a two-week log), …	CEO Trustee-led	0.25 d
Monthly dashboard and Board reporting	CEO	2 d
People, skills and resources map	A3	A4
People, skills and resources map, from the pre-start questions	CEO	0.5 d
Gaps and asks agreed: who gives what time	CEO Board	0.5 d
Impact, relationships and risk		A5
Relationship map: who holds what	CEO	0.5 d
Data protection check before the NICE appeal collec…	CEO Admin	0.5 d
Safeguarding review, including the online support gr…	CEO Admin	0.5 d
APPG funding from April 2027	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Impact measures and baselines, incl. underdiagnosed comm…	CEO	1.5 d
Relationships recorded in the supporter database	CEO Trustee-led	0.5 d
Insurance review for becoming an employer	CEO	0.5 d
External representation		A5
NICE guideline published (27 January): backstage su…	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Media protocol and spokesperson plan	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Representation at the pace the Board sets	CEO	1.5 d
More representation, as agreed	CEO	2 d
Media and communications capability		A5
What sustained media work needs: time, skills, budg…	CEO Trustee	1 d
Permanent CEO and handover		A6
Permanent role defined and costed; recruitment plan	CEO Board	1.5 d
Handover pack, if the contract ends at month 6	CEO	1 d
Recruitment: advert by mid-August, interviews in Se…	CEO Board	4 d
Final handover pack; a permanent CEO would start from Jan…	CEO	1 d



4 Before the start date: goodwill days

As goodwill on my side, not charged, and at times that suit you: getting to know everyone before the contract begins, so that day one starts with what is needed.

Contract signed 1

A contract for services, including confidentiality, signed before the introductions, for example in the last week of November. The contract clock starts on Monday 4 January.

Introductions 2

One-hour calls at times that suit you, with each trustee (including the trustees who joined in 2026) and the administrator.

Notes back 3

Written notes from each call within two days, for each person to add to.

Pre-start questions 4

About you, a two-week log of your Verity time, a list of Verity's systems, and key documents.

Day one, 4 January 5

Preparation, then a short debrief with everyone: anything else I need for my first two weeks.

If the appointment comes later, the same steps simply move, and funding deadlines that have passed drop out.

Pre-start questions for trustees and the administrator

- **About you:** Your skills, what you do for Verity today, what you would like to do in the longer term and what would be sustainable for you, the time you have for the transition, and your networks.
- **A two-week log of your Verity time:** Only the time you spend on Verity, not your whole day: what you do, when, for how long, and which skills it draws on. It is the baseline for test 3: trustees spending materially less time on operational delivery.
- **Systems list:** What Verity uses today, what you would like, what is missing, and who holds each account.

Documents and information, once the contract is signed

- The grant strategy
- Current funders, their grant end dates and terms
- The latest figures and management accounts
- Existing policies, insurance and registrations
- The 2027 Board dates
- How the APPG will be funded from April 2027
- The media set-up: budget, processes, who prepares
- Key relationships, and who holds them
- The NICE publication on 27 January: your plans and any embargo arrangements

First conversations in January

- How the interim role is funded
- The pace of the media and stakeholder handover, and which relationships trustees keep
- The Board's position on industry funding
- The days, salary and timing the Board has in mind for the permanent post

5 Team and resources: the people, skills and resources map

Who brings which skills, time and networks, and what each person would like to do. It is filled in from the pre-start questions, so for now every cell is a gap.

Role	Skills	Time for the transition	Time long term	Networks	What they would like to do
Chair	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Deputy Chair	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Treasurer	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Company Secretary	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Trustees who joined in 2026	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Administrator (part time)	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Volunteers	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*

6 What six months can deliver, and what it cannot

Six months at two days a week is enough to build the foundations properly. Securing the funding for a permanent CEO, and appointing one, depends on funders' decision times and a recruitment process, and realistically concludes around month twelve.

Six months at two days a week can deliver properly

- The roadmap agreed by the Board, with people, systems and money mapped
- The Board report, scheme of delegation and risk register in use
- The income strategy agreed, the pipeline live and the first applications in
- The employer-readiness plan signed off, providers chosen and policies drafted
- The permanent CEO role defined and costed, with a recruitment plan
- A handover pack

What it cannot, because of lead times rather than effort

- **The funding for a permanent CEO.** Trust decisions take 16 weeks to 6 months, so applications sent in months 2 to 4 are decided in months 6 to 10.
- **A permanent CEO in post.** A CEO search typically takes around six months, plus one to three months' notice, and it needs the funding to be reasonably clear first.
- **Employer systems fully in use.** They are only truly in use once someone is employed.
- **Trustee-dependent work at full speed.** Board reports need trustees' input, sign-offs wait for Board meetings, and relationship records need every trustee.

The roadmap therefore shows months 7 to 12 at one day a week, for modelling purposes only: it could be anything from none to two days a week, to be discussed and agreed. The table shows what each option would mean in total.

Months 7 to 12	Interim CEO days in total	What happens in months 7 to 12	A permanent CEO could start
None: six months only	58	Trustees lead, with the handover pack	Spring 2028 at the earliest
One day a week shown in the roadmap, for modelling only	84	Run the systems, steward funding decisions, recruit, hand over	January to March 2028
Two days a week (twelve months in all)	110	As one day a week, with more time for recruitment and income	January 2028

Weeks 1 and 2 at five days a week are my suggestion, not in the pack, to build momentum quickly; to be discussed and agreed. Without them, the first full roadmap would come around week 4 rather than week 2, leaving less time to test it with trustees before week 6. The pack offers a six-month contract "with view to extend up to 12 months" (page 12). Totals count two days every week after the ramp-up.

7 The main risks, and how the plan handles them

Risk	How the plan handles it
The main funder does not renew, or renews on narrower terms	Protect the existing funder first: an early conversation before January, then regular contact. Build several income streams so that no single funder dominates.
Two days a week against two large jobs	Priorities agreed with the Board in week 6. The dashboard shows each month's days, so trade-offs are visible and decided, not discovered. About four and a half days in months 1 to 6 are left unallocated for the day-to-day and the unexpected; the trustees' time logs show how much day-to-day work there is, and the full roadmap in week 2 makes room for it.
Most income is restricted to specific purposes, and a permanent CEO needs core or multi-year funding	Unrestricted and multi-year funding first, and a fair share of core costs in every project bid.
Safeguarding in the online support groups, with over 12,000 members	A review in the first months, with clear moderation and reporting routes, before Verity becomes an employer.
Relationships and knowledge held by individuals	A relationship map recorded in a supporter database, and processes written down, so that knowledge belongs to Verity.

8 Beyond the interim: what a permanent team would need (2028 to 2030)

For the Board to shape. A three-year horizon fits multi-year core grants (one to three years), the renaming's managed three-year transition, and a first strategy cycle for a permanent CEO. The longer direction is the mission itself, reviewed every year.

INCOME	PEOPLE	GOVERNANCE	SYSTEMS	MISSION
Several income streams so that no single funder dominates; multi-year core grants; regular giving; earned income including PMOS TIME; a reserves policy; the APPG funded separately.	The permanent CEO in post; a staffing map shaped by the people-and-systems decision; clear volunteer roles; media work that does not rest on one person.	Scheme of delegation, Board report and risk register embedded; a Board skills and renewal plan; an annual review.	Supporter database; finance, HR and media processes; the dashboard with login and comments; plus additional systems, to be mapped.	NICE implementation; the renaming's managed three-year transition, with the new name integrated into the 2028 international guideline update; the APPG's recommendations; the research priorities; reach into underdiagnosed communities.

9 What this dashboard does now, and what I would add

A snapshot built from public information. It shows what Verity and its Interim CEO need to deliver, and by when: who does what, how many days each step takes, and how long it waits on others, with every figure marked as real, an estimate or still a gap. Each month the same page would show progress against the plan agreed in week 6.

- **Secure login:** Password-protected access.
- **Comments in one place:** Trustees, the team and invited partners can comment on any item, so all input sits together.
- **One source of truth:** Updated each month from one spreadsheet, so the Board pack is produced, not written.
- **Views for different people:** The Board sees everything, the team their own actions, invited partners only what they are shown.
- **Owners update their own work:** Each owner updates the status of their own steps.
- **A history:** Each month's version is kept, so progress and decisions can be traced.
- **Reminders and export:** Deadline reminders from the calendar, and a PDF for the Board papers.
- **Safe by design:** No personal or health data on the dashboard, and access logged.

Sources

- **Verity Interim CEO application pack and advert**: September 2026
- **Verity's filed accounts to 31 March 2025**: Charity Commission, charity 1097599
- **Charity Commission and Companies House registers**: read 16 October 2026
- **NICE project page GID-NG10436**: expected publication 27 January 2027, read 17 October 2026
- **Register of All-Party Parliamentary Groups**: 1 September 2026 edition
- **Funders' own websites**: The Fore, Rosa, Hospital Saturday Fund, Garfield Weston, National Lottery Awards for All, Big Give, read 6 to 16 October 2026
- **The Waterloo Foundation annual report 2025**: page 16
- **GOV.UK employer guidance**: PAYE, workplace pensions, employers' liability insurance, right to work; read 16 October 2026
- **Verity's website and social media pages**: read 16 and 17 October 2026

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